

Illustrative Example:

You are Shantanu / Shanaya Sehgal of New Modern School, Acharya Atre Marg, Wadala, Mumbai – 400 031.

A1. Formal Letter

Write a letter to the Yogacharya at Yog Sansthan, Dombivli (East), Mumbai – 421201, inviting him to inaugurate the 'yoga club' at your school.

OR

A2. Informal Letter

Write a letter to your mother, telling her about the inauguration ceremony of the yoga club at your school. The address of your hostel is Block C, 214, New Modern School Campus, Acharya Atre Marg, Wadala, Mumbai – 400 031.

A1. Shantanu Sehgal,
New Modern School,
Acharya Atre Marg,
Wadala,
Mumbai – 400 031

16th February, 2019

Sender's
address and ½ Mark
date

To,
The Yogacharya
Yog Sansthan,
Dombivli (East),
Mumbai – 421201

Recipient's
address ½ Mark

Subject: Invitation to inaugurate yoga club.

Subject and
Salutation ½ Mark

Respected Sir,

Your expertise as a *yogacharya* is known to all of us. You are an icon for today's generation. The way you have spread awareness about the necessity of yoga towards leading a healthy and fit life is indeed admirable. Therefore, on behalf of our school, I would like to extend an invitation to you to inaugurate our school's new yoga club.

Your presence would be inspiring for all of us and your valuable advice on the great science of Yoga would be a source of motivation. We are aware that you may be busy, but we sincerely request you to take our invitation under consideration. The inauguration is scheduled for 9:00 a.m. on 28th February, 2019 in the recreation hall of our school. Kindly let the bearer of this letter know your response.

Body of
the letter 2 Mark

I truly hope that you grace the inauguration ceremony with your presence.

Yours sincerely,
Shantanu Sehgal

Subscription/
Closing ½ Mark

Correct use of Grammar in the letter. 1 Mark

Q7. 'Imagine you are Rohit/ Richa residing at, Sainik Colony, Pune 411051.'

'Science Exhibition'

A1. Formal Letter:

Write a letter to a famous scientist inviting him/her as a Chief Guest of the 'Science Day Celebration' of your school.

OR

A2. Informal Letter:

Write a letter to your friend Anup/ Anita describing him/her about the Prize won by group in the Science Exhibition.

[SSC Board Question Bank]

A1. New Heights International School,
Rohit Sharma,
Sainik Colony,
Pune – 411051
18th March, 2021

To,
Head of the Department,
Space Research Organisation,
31-B, Pragat Colony,
M.G. Road, Nagpur – 440015

Subject: Invitation for the 'Science Day Celebration' as the Chief Guest

Respected Sir / Ma'am,

I, Rohit Malhotra, am a student of New Heights International School. I also hold the position of the school captain. I am writing this letter on behalf of my school to cordially invite you as the Chief Guest to our school's 'Science day celebration' on 25th March, 2021.

The event will begin at 9:00 am, with a small inaugural ceremony. There will be various science models, demonstrations and experiments exhibited by the students of 5th to 12th grade. The goal behind this is to encourage the students to strive for the best, along with providing a platform to boost their morale and confidence. The science day celebration is our school's step towards encouraging students in the field of science. We are in awe of your powerful yet humble personality. Your achievements in the field of science are extraordinary and commendable and your words of encouragement would positively impact all the students.

Please grace us with your presence and join us in encouraging the students as well as in making the celebration a grand success.

Thank you.

Yours truly,
Rohit

Q6. 'Imagine you are Saurabh/Soha Das residing at, Parijat Colony, Pune 411051.'

'Historical Monument- A National Treasure.'

A1. Formal Letter:

Write a letter to the Municipal Commissioner requesting him/her to take a strict action against those who spoil the beauty and purity of the Historical Places.

OR

A2. Informal Letter:

Write a letter to your friend Rohan/Rima describing him/her about your visit to a famous Historical Place.

[SSC Board Question Bank]

A1. FORMAL LETTER

Soha Das,
Parijat Colony,
Pune – 411051

20th March, 2021

To,
The Municipal Commissioner
Municipal Corporation of Pune
Pune – 411050

Subject: Penalising visitors for ruining the beauty and purity of historical places.

Respected Madam,

I, Soha Das, a class X student of Ideal High School, Pune. With great disappointment, I'd like to bring to your kind attention, the pathetic condition of the nearby historical places. They are in a sorry state of affairs for which the irresponsible visitors are to be blamed.

A few days ago, I had the opportunity to visit the famous Lal Mahal, one of the historical places in Pune. I am greatly disturbed over the state in which the site is maintained. The monument is in ruins and the place is unclean.

I would like to suggest that the visitors who indulge into the destruction of the historical place through any means and amount, need to be penalised as they are no less than miscreants. They shouldn't be spared at any cost. This would lead to a better condition of the place as well as people inculcating a good civic sense. We could have a CCTV camera in place to monitor the troublemakers. Placards and sign boards could be placed in strategic places to warn as well as guide visitors. Sufficient and well-maintained sanitary facilities could be provided to ensure the cleanliness of the place. The involvement of the locals would be like cherry on cake.

I kindly request you to keep us updated about the happenings at the site. My friends and I would be keen to do our part in protecting this very precious Heritage site.

Yours sincerely,

Soha Das

Q17. Read the following instructions given by Mumbai Police Department before the celebration of Holi; and write a letter based on the same.

**DON'T LET HOLI LOSE
ALL ITS COLOURS**

Mumbai Police urges you to avoid the following for a safe Holi:

- Throwing water/coloured water or rubber balloons containing water at passersby.
- Colouring people without their consent.
- Eve-teasing
- Drink and drive
- Using dirt and chemicals instead of natural colours.
- Triple-riding on two-wheelers.
- Riding without a helmet.

You are Raj/Rajani Malhotra, residing at 101, Shivsiddhivinayak Apartment, Vileparle, Mumbai-400057.

A1. Formal Letter:

Write a letter to the Commissioner of Police, Mumbai thanking him for the instructions and appealing advertisement.

OR

A2. Informal Letter:

Write a letter to your friend Rohan/Rohini appealing him/her to play 'Safe Holi'. Make use of the points given in the advertisement. You may add your own points.

[March 2023]

A1. Rajani Malhotra,
101, Shivsiddhivinayak Apartment,
Vileparle,
Mumbai – 400057,
Maharashtra
1st March, 2023

To,
Commissioner of Police,
Mumbai Police Department,
Mumbai,
Maharashtra

Subject: Thank-you note for the Informative and Impactful Advertisement to play safe Holi.

Respected Sir,

I am writing this letter to express my gratitude and appreciation for the recent advertisement issued by the Mumbai Police Department to play a safe Holi. The Safety measures and guidelines provided in the advertisement were very informative and useful. I am sure the advertisement will play a crucial role in ensuring that this year's Holi will be celebrated safely and without any major incidents.

Firstly, as a resident of Mumbai, I was heartened to see the advertisement which was not only well-crafted and visually appealing but also conveyed the importance of celebrating Holi in a responsible and safe manner. Secondly, as a girl residing in Mumbai, I am extremely thankful for shedding light on the topic of eve-teasing which is always a major concern especially during festivals like Holi.

I want to express my gratitude to the Mumbai Police Department for taking this initiative to create awareness among the public and for ensuring the safety of the citizens during the festival. Your efforts have and will always help in creating a safer environment for everyone during Holi.

I hope the Mumbai Police Department continues to take similar initiatives in the future and I wish you all the best for your future endeavours.

Thanking you in anticipation.

Yours faithfully,
Rajani Malhotra

Q20. Imagine you are Bhavin / Bhavana residing at C-101, Manohar C.H.S., Mumbai, 400050.

Attempt any one of the following letters based on the given situation.

“Indian Historic Monuments among Most Poorly Managed”

A1. Formal Letter

Write a letter to the Minister of Tourism of Maharashtra complaining about the shocking state of affairs at one of the monuments you have recently visited.

OR

A2. Informal Letter

Write a letter to your friend Amish / Amisha explaining the part that can be played by tourists towards the protection and preservation of a monument they visit.

Q21. Imagine you are Krunal / Krutika residing at 10-B/504, Ashtavinayak C.H.S., Satara, 415001.

Attempt any one of the following letters based on the given situation.

“Old Age Homes Rising in the City”

A1. Formal Letter

Write a letter to the Editor, Satara Daily, Satara, 415002, voicing your concern over the increasing number of old age homes in the city.

OR

A2. Informal Letter

Write a letter to your friend Lakshya / Lavanya discussing the values that need to be adopted by the younger generation to care for their elders.

Q22. Imagine you are Yash / Yashika residing at Plot No. 2, Basant Niwas, Amravati, 444601.

Attempt any one of the following letters based on the given situation.

DEPLORABLE ROAD CONDITIONS

– by a Staff Reporter

12th Oct, Amravati:

Residents of Basant Niwas are left annoyed and irritated by the worsening conditions of the roads in the area. Formation of potholes has led to increased risk of accidents.....

A1. Formal Letter

Write a letter to the Municipal Commissioner, Municipal Offices Complex, Amravati, 444602, complaining about the poor condition of roads and the inconvenience caused due to it.

OR

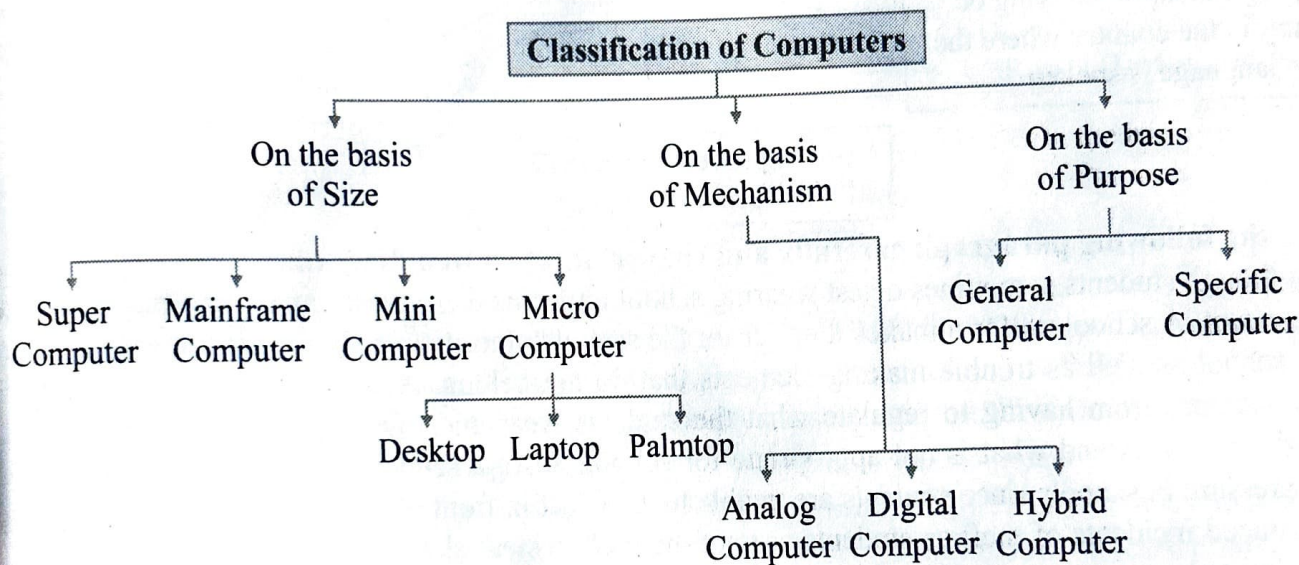
A2. Informal Letter

Write a letter to your friend Vinay / Vinaya making him / her aware of the threats to public safety due to the poor condition of roads.

Q13. Read the following paragraph carefully and convert it into a tree diagram.

Computers may be classified on the basis of size, mechanism or purpose. When classified on the basis of size, computers can be divided into super computers, mainframe computers, mini computers and micro computers. The most popular devices that we all use these days i.e. desktops, laptops and palmtops are sub-classifications of micro computers. When classified on the basis of mechanism, computers can be divided into analog computers, digital computers and hybrid computers. Lastly, when classified on the basis of purpose, computers can be divided into general and specific computers.

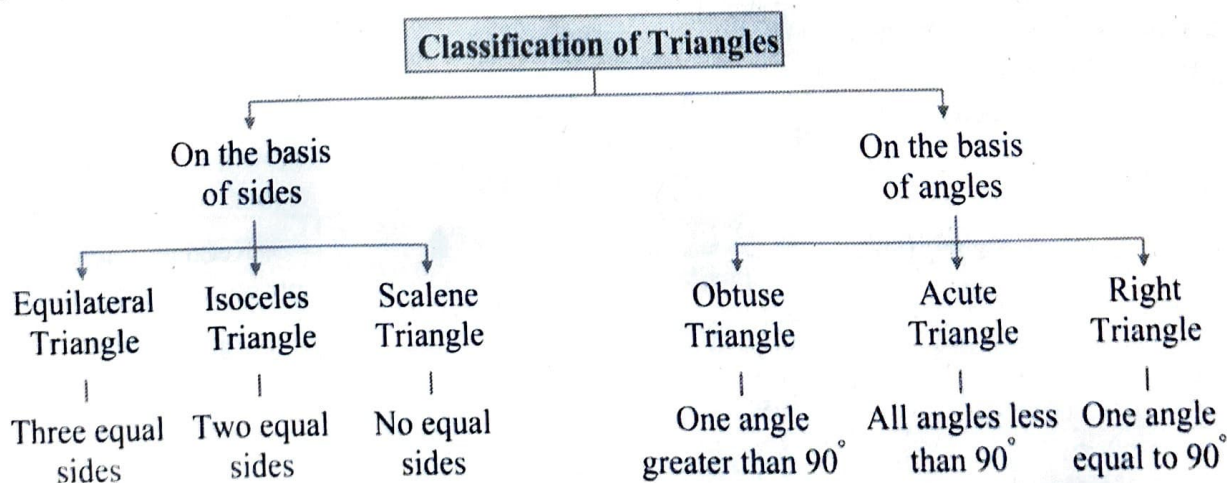
Ans:



Q14. Read the following paragraph carefully and convert it into a tree diagram.

Triangles are three-sided, three-angled polygons. Thus, they can be classified on the basis of sides as well as on the basis of angles. When classified on the basis of size, they can be divided into equilateral triangles (having three equal sides), isosceles triangles (having two equal sides) and scalene triangles (having no equal sides). On the other hand, when classified on the basis of angles, they can be classified into obtuse triangles (having one angle greater than 90 degrees), acute triangles (having all angles smaller than 90 degrees) and right triangles (having one angle equal to 90 degrees).

Ans:

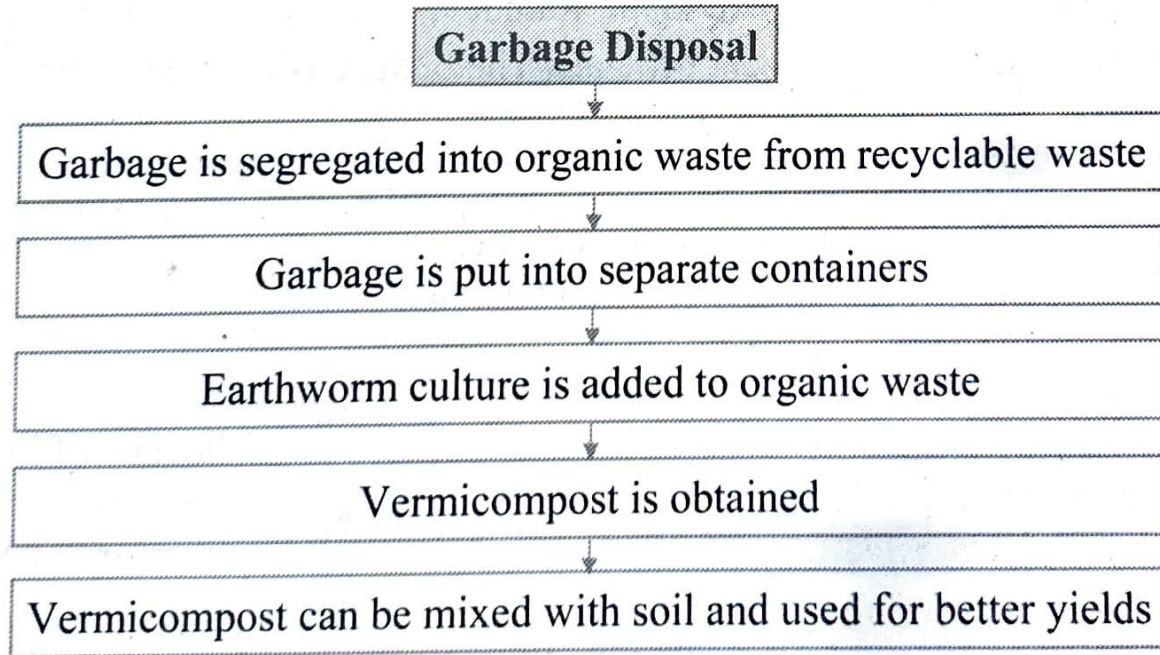


Paragraph to Flow Chart

Q20. Read the following paragraph carefully and convert it into a flow chart.

Garbage disposal has become a great problem in urban areas. Lots of garbage is being collected from every household. Some cities have come up with innovative ideas to tackle this problem. First of all, the garbage in trucks is segregated into organic waste from recyclable waste. Then it is put into separate containers. Earthworm culture is added to this organic waste. After a few weeks the conversion process is complete and what we can get is vermicompost which is very good quality compost that can be mixed with soil and used for better yields.

Ans:

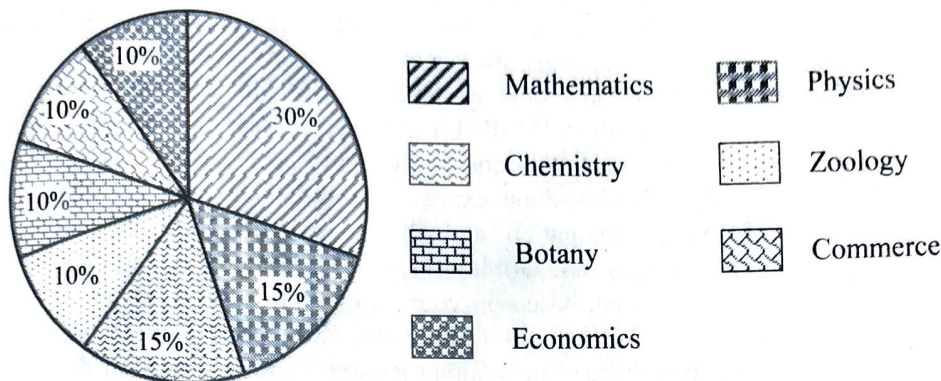


Q26. Read the following paragraph carefully and convert it into a pie chart.

According to the survey conducted by Midtown High School, 30% of the students stated that they were gearing up for a career in the field of Mathematics. Physics and Chemistry were found to be equally interesting as 15% of the students opted for each subject. Zoology, Botany, Commerce and Economics lagged behind and were opted for, by only 10% of all students, for each subject.

Ans:

Subjects Opted for by Student of Midtown High School

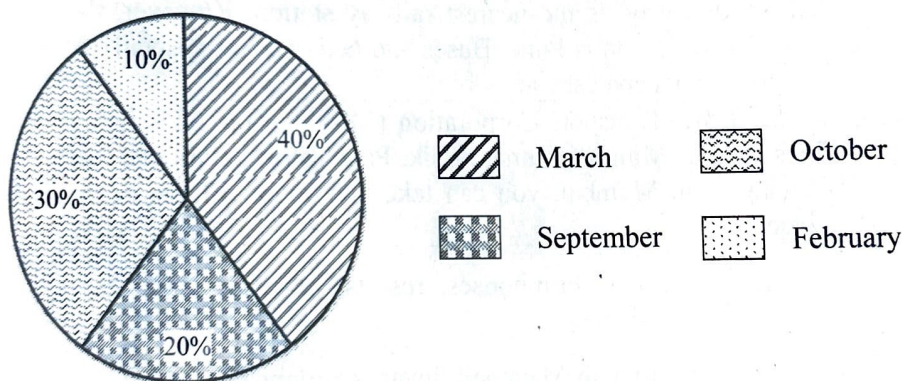


Q27. Read the following paragraph carefully and convert it into a pie chart.

The sale of air conditioners is highly influenced by the weather and hence 40% of all units sold by A1 Electronics were sold in March. During the cool monsoon months of July and August no units were sold whereas 20% and 30% of all units sold were sold in September and October respectively. The remaining 10% of all units sold were sold during the month of February probably in anticipation of the summer heat.

Ans:

Sale of Air Conditioners by A1 Electronics in different months

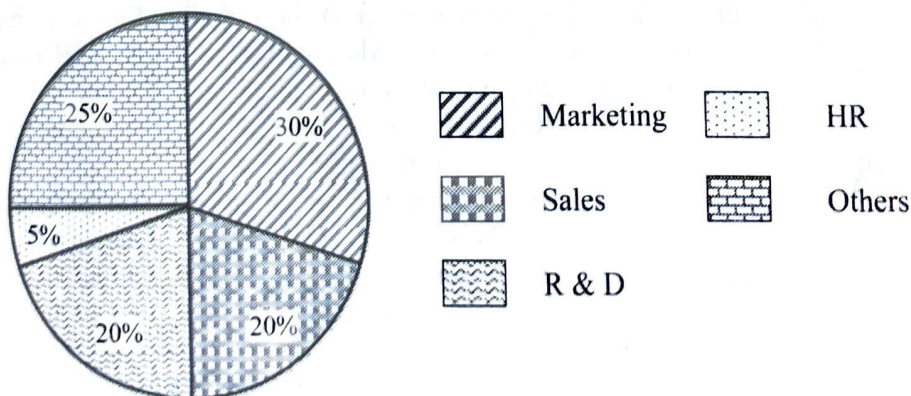


Q28. Read the following paragraph carefully and convert it into a pie chart.

Ace Pharmaceuticals is a multinational corporation based in New Zealand. According to the most recent report submitted by the HR department, 30% of all employees work in the Marketing Department. The Sales Department and the R&D Department, each, comprise 20% of the workforce of the company. The HR department itself is the smallest department of the company comprising of only 5% of all employees. The remaining employees are a part of other departments such as Supply Chain Management, Business Development, Accounting etc.

Ans:

Employees in Different Departments of Ace Pharmaceuticals



Paragraph to Fact File

Q31. Using information given in the following extract, complete the table given below:

Mahatma Gandhi was born on 2nd October, 1869. He completed law from England and returned to India. He was keen on helping the poor and down-trodden. He is internationally known for his work in South Africa where he fought against racial discrimination. He began the Satyagraha Movement and initiated a major agitation in the form of a Civil-disobedience Movement against the British in 1930, followed by the Quit India Movement in 1942. He died on 30th January, 1948. He was bestowed with the title 'Father of the Nation'.

Name	
Date of Birth	
Academic qualifications	
Aim in life	
Work in South Africa	
Two major movements	
Title given to Gandhiji	
Date of death	

Ans:

Fact File: Mahatma Gandhi

Name	Mahatma Gandhi
Date of Birth	2 nd October, 1869
Academic qualifications	Law (from England)
Aim in life	To help the poor and down-trodden
Work in South Africa	Fought against racial discrimination
Two major movements	Civil-disobedience and Quit India Movement
Title given to Gandhiji	Father of the Nation
Date of death	30 th January, 1948

Q5. Prepare a speech to be delivered by you in the 'Interschool Elocution Competition,' on account of the 'Teacher's Day'.

Topic: 'Salute to the teachers'

[SSC Board Question Bank]

Hints:

- an excellent educator
- teaches from the heart, not just from the book
- hard-working and motivated
- brightens a soul with its light
- resourceful and dedicated

Ans:

Salute to the teachers

Good morning, Respected Principal, teachers and my dear friends. I, Master Tarun Patel, would take this golden opportunity to welcome all of you on the occasion of teacher's day celebration.

A teacher introduces child to the social life. They are not only an excellent educator but also a great source of knowledge for the students. They teach from the heart, not just from the book. By putting their mindshare, they brighten and enlighten the soul of the students.

Teachers are hardworking and self-motivated, their resourcefulness and dedication is the key which transforms a student's overall personality. We acknowledge and appreciate the work our teachers put in.

To sum it up all, I'd like to say:

TEACHING: THE PROFESSION THAT CREATES OTHER PROFESSIONS.

Thank you everyone. A big salute to the teachers.

Q6. Prepare a speech to be delivered by you on account of the Republic Day.

Topic: 'How to build a new India.'

Hints:

- unity in diversity
- education
- sacrifices of the freedom fighters
- pollution free

[SSC Board Question Bank]

Ans:

How to build a new India

Respected principal, teachers and my dear friends, today we are celebrating Republic Day, the day our Indian constitution came into effect in 1950, and on this occasion, I would like to share my thoughts on "How to build a better India."

India is the world's largest democracy. We are a huge nation of people belonging to all castes and religions, living together in harmony. We are one big family. We all are here today, enjoying freedom, because of the countless sacrifices these freedom fighters made. They did not fight for a specific community or caste, but for everyone. They fought with their lives, for us to live and breathe freely. The free and prospering India of today is their gift to us. The youth holds the power to build a new India, towards progress and betterment. Now, it is our responsibility to continue their legacy and do something for our nation and its betterment.

Issues like poverty, corruption and environmental pollution are eating the very core of this nation. We, as responsible citizens, need to bring this to a permanent stop. By adapting eco-friendly and green policies, by reusing, reducing and recycling, and by participating in effective waste management, we can lead a sustainable lifestyle that is not only great for us but also for the nation.

For India to be stronger, better and advanced, education is the utmost important step. Educating every citizen, especially those who have been deprived of this privilege, should be our first aim. Educated and learned citizens will become the country's strength, providing power and driving the country higher. Let's take a step forward to bridge this gap of imbalance. When every citizen joins hands for a new India, a better India, we can undoubtedly achieve the dream.

Every action matters, so let us pledge to bring the change we want for India to be reborn. Jai Hind!

Board Exam Questions

Q12. Prepare a speech to be delivered for District level Elocution Competition. The subject given to you is 'How to live a happy and joyful life'. [March 2019]

Use the following points:

- Live in a stress free atmosphere
- Be in the company of cheerful people
- Daily meditation and exercise
- Take inspiration from great people

Ans:

How to live a happy and joyful life

Good morning, judges and everyone in the audience. I, Vishal Kamath, from Paramount School, Mulund, am here to speak on the importance of the factors that help us live a happy and joyful life in today's stressful world.

Since health is the key to happiness, it's important for us to live in an environment that promotes both mental and physical health. It needs to be supplemented by regular exercise, meditation and personal hygiene, which will help us keep bodily toxins and flab away. We must stay in the company of positive and enthusiastic people, who cheer us along the way. We should also seek inspiration from great people who have left their mark on the world. We can do so by reading or watching about them and even meeting them to understand their worldview and to try to apply it in our own lives.

Friends, it's crucial to keep our heads over water during stressful situations. I am sure we can all live a meaningful, happy and joyous life by adhering to the aforementioned suggestions.

Thank you all for listening to me patiently.

Q13. Prepare a speech to be delivered in the school assembly on 'Science and spirituality go hand in hand'. [July 2019]

Use the following points:

- Can work together
- Give scope for reasoning and thinking
- Can make more and more discoveries
- Can explain lot of things of life
- Can give scope for intelligence and creativity

Ans:

Science and Spirituality go hand-in-hand

Good morning, Respected Principal, teachers and my dear schoolmates. I, Nitya Sinha, would like to share with all of you the reasons why science and spirituality go hand-in-hand.

Science and spirituality are complementary to each other, with science being backed by logic and spirituality being backed by faith. Science helps us find the answers to the questions about the universe; it helps to discover and invent. On the other hand, faith provides focus, which is essential in witnessing how the discoveries and inventions benefit society. Together they can provide answers to various mysteries of life. Only when science and faith exist in harmony, can we live in a well-developed society. A balanced approach develops scope for reasoning and thinking. Science provides for limitless possibilities and faith helps us decide the extent to which we can progress without causing a negative impact on society. We become well informed, enlightened and develop a creative approach. Science and spirituality functioning true to their roles can be the answer to the enigma of the universe and the various discoveries yet to be made. Let us take a pledge to bring about a change in our outlook towards science and spirituality. Let us develop a more balanced approach towards both to build a better society.

Thank you.

Questions for Practice

Q18. 8th January marks the birth anniversary of the renowned scientist, Dr. Stephen Hawking. Your school has organised a talk session titled, 'Towards the development of a scientific attitude' in his honour. As the Student Council President, you are supposed to give an opening speech for this session. Draft your speech with the help of the following points:

- Stephen Hawking's life and important work
- Values that one can learn from Stephen Hawking
- The development of science and technology today
- Benefits of a scientific attitude for the younger generation

Q19. Prepare a speech to be delivered by you during the school assembly on 'Conservation of Electricity'. Draft your speech with the help of the following points:

- Limited resources available for generation of electricity
- Emission of greenhouse gases during generation of electricity
- Loss of time and money during instances of power failure
- Ways to conserve electricity

Q20. Draft a speech on the topic 'Advantages of Cashless Transactions' with the help of the following points:

- | | |
|--|--|
| • Convenience of not having to carry cash | • Protection against theft / misplacement of money |
| • Reduction in money laundering due to paper trail | • Easy currency exchange during international travel |

Q21. Prepare a speech to be delivered by you on 'Benefits of Healthy Habits' at your school. Include the following points in your speech:

- | | |
|--|-------------------------------|
| • Need of healthy habits in students' life | • Effects of unhealthy habits |
| • Reduces stress and keeps one happy | |

God's consideration. Man must also never be arrogant. He must never believe that there are no limits to his abilities because God can see farther than he will ever be able to.

Q18. Expand the following idea into a paragraph of 100 words: 'Knowledge is power'

Ans: Knowledge is power

The meaning of this proverb is that when a person gains knowledge he also gains the power to act upon said knowledge. He gains the power to make informed decisions as well as to decide the grounds on which he wants to make said decisions. Each book that one reads, each documentary that one watches, adds to one's bank of knowledge. Each perspective that one comes across has the potential to change one's life forever. Hence, knowledge must be seen as a source of power and not merely a collection of facts that one is aware of. The message of this proverb is that of lifelong learning. One must not let one's schooling be the end of one's education.

Q19. Expand the following idea into a paragraph of 100 words: 'Experience is the best teacher'

Ans: Experience is the best teacher

Throughout our lives we come across several pieces of advice, numerous quotes and various parables. However, it is only when we experience a situation ourselves do we truly understand it. For example, a child may be warned to always make sure that his or her shoelaces are tied. However, he or she may or may not heed such a warning. But if the child actually trips and falls due to untied shoelaces, the experience will teach them that untied shoelaces can cause a lot of pain. Hence, theoretical knowledge is important but it is practical knowledge, one that is gained by experience that stays with a person for their entire lifetime.

Q20. Expand the following idea into a paragraph of 100 words: 'Humour is the spice of life'

Ans: Humour is the spice of life

No matter how well food is cooked, it would not be delicious without spices. In the same vein, no matter how well one lives their life, it would not be blissful without humour. Humour is an indispensable part of our lives which helps us form meaningful connections with others by finding common ground with them. In the words of Danish comedian Victor Borge, "Humour is the shortest distance between two people". The proverb encourages people to be cheerful and happy in spite of the troubles in their life. It conveys to them that thinking positively and having a sense of humour will serve them well in all kinds of circumstances.

Q21. Expand the following idea into a paragraph of 100 words: 'The child is the father of man'

Ans: The child is the father of man

Though the abovementioned proverb sounds paradoxical, its meaning is surprisingly straightforward. Taken from the poem, 'My Heart Leaps Up' by William Wordsworth, it means that adulthood is nothing but a projection of childhood. Since, a child grows up to become a man; childhood is the most important period in one's life. In other words, parents must instil in a child, good values and a spirit of curiosity because these qualities will be carried by the child into adulthood. Also, these qualities will dictate the kind of man the child becomes; one that is loved and respected by all or one that all avoid like the plague.

Q22. Expand the theme:

Expand the following idea into 100 words:

'Travelling broadens our mind'

[SSC Board Question Bank]

Ans: Travelling broadens our mind

Travelling broadens the perspective and mind. It helps you to think outside the safe cocoon. It improves social skills as you meet a lot of people from different places. Travelling experience makes you come out of your comfort zone as it is not about luxury and comfort, it is about beholding the beautiful bouquet that the world has to offer and experience it. The serenity of nature and beauty of historical places mesmerize you by leaving you calm and composed. Exploring new destination boosts confidence as you get to meet and see new people and surrounding. It unwinds you and makes you more receptive towards life. Getting to know different cultures and traditions and appreciating them is another advantage of travelling. The biggest learning of travelling is to value experience over worldly things.

Q23. Expand the theme:

Expand the following idea into 100 words:

'Health Is Wealth'

[SSC Board Question Bank]

Ans: Health is Wealth

Health is not a luxury everyone is blessed with. "Health is wealth" is a saying that can be found in almost any language or culture, and it is absolutely true. If you lose your health, nothing else in life holds importance.

Health deteriorates for many reasons. Illnesses can occur at any point, and so, we need to invest our time and effort on our wellbeing and health. Good physical as well as mental health ensures a smooth lifestyle. A balanced and controlled lifestyle with enough attention to healthy food, proper exercise, balanced diet and intake of water and nutrients is required. Apart from that, mental health and wellbeing should also be treated equally.

Balance of healthy and tasty food, fun and fitness is the ideal way to take care of the biggest gift we have received: our body.

Q24. Expand the following idea into a paragraph of 100 words: 'Nature – The Best Teacher' [March 2019]

Ans: Nature – The Best Teacher

Nature is the reason that life came into existence on earth. Whether it's the calm and composed environment around us that creates ecosystems and supports life or the innumerable natural disasters that wipe out entire settlements, nature constantly teaches us something new. The wind teaches us to be constantly on the move and never to be stagnant in life. The trees teach us to stand tall, despite the difficulties we face. Water teaches us to adapt to different situations. The soil, despite birthing millions of plants and crops, teaches us the importance of being down-to-earth. The tidal waves teach us that no matter how high you soar, you will eventually come down. But instead of giving up, you should rise again. Each and every being in nature teaches us crucial life lessons. It is up to us to learn from them, because nature is the best teacher!

Q25. Expand the following idea into a paragraph of 100 words: 'A bad workman blames his tools' [July 2019]

Ans: A bad workman blames his tools

This famous proverb lays emphasis on the importance of accountability. A workman, who is bad at his work, blames his tools and not himself. Blaming his tools is the workman's way of not owning up to his mistakes; for not taking responsibility for a job done poorly. The workman does not take ownership for a job done poorly because he would lose his credibility. Blaming everything and everyone but himself, citing excuses, pointing fingers are the ways the workman tries to cover for his incompetence. This proverb is suitable for people who lack certain skill sets or qualities and instead of improving themselves; they make excuses by blaming their product or performance on external factors.

Q26. Expand the following idea into a paragraph of 100 words: 'Be the change you want to see' [March 2020]

Ans: Be the change you want to see

We must first change ourselves in order to change the thoughts of a society. We all preach various slogans, 'Save the girl child', 'Green India', 'Ban Plastic', 'Save the Environment' and so on; but only a few of us contribute towards these causes. It is true that changing the thoughts of society is a herculean task. However, if one person is successful in doing so, then he can bring about a revolution. Mahatma Gandhi himself moulded the views of society towards justice and non-violence. But to do so, he first changed himself, proving that a good leader can change the entire nation. Similarly, we need to change ourselves and mend our ways. Let us throw our wrappers in dustbins, turn off our taps while brushing and so on. Let's work for the 'Swatchh Bharat Abhiyaan' and other social movements, spread awareness and be the change that we want to see.

Q27. Expand the following idea into a paragraph of 100 words: 'Actions speak louder than words' [Dec 2020]

Ans: Actions speak louder than words

As Paulo Coelho has said, "The world is changed by your example, not by your opinion". Today, everyone wants to assert their opinions and beliefs. Everyone has some expert advice to give regarding everything that happens in the world. But a close look at their lives would reveal that many a time their actions do not support their words. It is easy to talk about bravery and about how a soldier should not think twice before laying down his life. However, only when it comes to implementation, does one realise how difficult that is. Thus, it is easy to criticise people's actions, but difficult to lead lives that would be examples. And we must remember that if a person's words are not backed by actions, they are being hypocritical. So, if we want to form an opinion about a person, we should watch their actions instead of listening to their words.

Q28. Expand the following idea into 100 words: "The time to be happy is now". [Mar 2022]

Ans: The time to be happy is now

Many a time, people postpone their happiness by tying it to an event or an accomplishment. Some are stuck in their past and some believe that going on the perfect vacation or landing the perfect job would entitle them to happiness and until such things happen they cannot be happy. By doing so, they treat their life like a check-list wherein every goal they meet points them towards the goals that they are yet to meet. And thus, happiness always remains in the form of a past memory or in the distant future. However, the belief that happiness is, something we cherished in the past or something to be attained; something that depends on how the past was or what the future holds, is simply a misconception. In the words of Sydney Harris, 'Happiness is a direction, not a place'. Wherever someone is in their life and whatever they have achieved, they can be happy right there and then. All they need to do is to re-examine their lives and look for things to be grateful for.

Q10. Read the given leaflet and prepare a news report.

Blood Donation Camp

- i. Arranged on the Independence Day
- ii. Inaugurated by Dr. R. C. Patil, Vice-Chancellor of Armed Forces Medical College, Pune
- iii. Free medical check-up before blood donation
- iv. Nutritious refreshments served for donors
- v. Attend one and all
- vi. Organised by EST Hospital, Raviwar Peth, Pune

Ans:

Blood Donation Camp

- Anurag Singh, Student Staff Reporter

Pune, 10th August, 2016

A blood donation camp is being organized by EST Hospital, Raviwar Peth, Pune. The camp is scheduled to be held on the Independence Day i.e., 15th August, 2016 between 9 a.m. to 5 p.m. at Jyoti Vidyaniketan, Raviwar Peth, Pune.

The camp will be inaugurated by Honourable Dr. R.C. Patil, the Vice-Chancellor of the Armed Forces Medical College, Pune. Arrangements are being made for a free medical check-up before blood donation. Nutritious refreshments will be served for the donors after the noble deed of donating blood. The organisers are appealing to the masses, especially to the younger generation to come forward to donate blood. This camp aims at creating awareness about social responsibilities. An enthusiastic participation of the youth is expected for the same. The camp invites one and all to shoulder this noble social responsibility.

Q11. Your school recently celebrated its Annual Tree Plantation Day. Akhil Jain, an environmental activist known for his efforts in battling deforestation, presided over the occasion as the Chief Guest. Prepare a report for your school magazine using the following points:

- i. Date and time
- ii. Tree plantation ceremony
- iii. Skit performed by students
- iv. Speech by the Chief Guest

Ans:

Annual Tree Plantation Day

- Suyash Joshi, Student Staff Reporter

Mumbai, 10th June, 2016

Swami Vivekananda High School recently celebrated its Annual Tree Plantation Day on 5th June, 2016. The programme is organised every year to coincide with the World Environment Day, with a view to remind the students of the importance of the environment.

The programme started sharp at 9 a.m. with an inauguration ceremony, where the Principal, Mr. Bhardwaj, presented a sapling to the Chief Guest, Mr. Akhil Jain. He also spoke a few words about Mr. Jain's achievements during his career as an environmental activist.

The tree plantation in the school playground began at around 9:30 a.m. More than 75 fruit saplings comprising of mango, pomegranate, papaya, guava, lemon etc. were planted. The students enthusiastically planted these saplings and also took an oath to look after them.

Later, students of Std. VIII, IX and X performed a skit promoting afforestation which was followed by a heartfelt speech by the Chief Guest. The programme thus turned out to be quite a memorable one.

Q12. Prepare a news report on the following:

'Traffic Police Commissioner conducts a lecture series, to enlighten the students about safe driving.'

[SSC Board Question Bank]

Ans:

Safety Driving Lessons

- Rohan Kaushik, Student Staff Reporter

Mumbai, 20th March, 2021

Due to the increasing number of road accidents involving young students, the traffic commissioner of Mumbai city along with the help of the entire traffic department, announced a series of lectures for students, to educate and enlighten them.

It was noted that students, especially those who recently received their licences, were unaware of the threat of driving in a metropolitan city like Mumbai. The series includes four lectures, each to be conducted online on Sundays in the month of March. Two lectures have already been conducted, talking about road safety, first aid and traffic rules. This has received a tremendous response and students all over the city are joining and learning.

It is a great initiative, which has already helped with raising and spreading essential information. It has impacted hundreds of students and is continuing to do so.

Q15. Prepare a news report based on the following headline:

[March 2019] [SSC Board Question Bank]

'14 Child Labourers Were Rescued From Firework Factory'

Ans:

14 Child Labourers Were Rescued From Firework Factory

- Rohan Kaushik, Student Staff Reporter

Sivakasi, 11th December, 2019

Fourteen innocent children in the age group of nine to thirteen years were found being exploited by an owner of a fireworks factory in Sivakasi, Tamil Nadu. They were illegally being made to work in highly hazardous conditions, in exchange for food and shelter.

These kids, eight boys and six girls, were victims of human trafficking and were brought in from other states to avoid detection. They belonged to poor families whose parents had earlier sold them as bonded labourers. These facts came to light after a police raid on the factory premises in wee hours of 10th December. The proprietor of the firm was arrested along with two human traffickers who were present inside the factory.

The inspector who led the raid commented, "This firework factory had been on our radar for quite some time. For the past two weeks, we were collecting evidence against the proprietor and the human traffickers. With enough evidence to arrest them, we successfully conducted the raid yesterday".

Q16. Prepare a news report based on the following headline:

[July 2019]

'Snatch Theft is on the Rise'

Use the given information:

While shopping in your local market you witnessed a theft take place. The thief was not caught.

Points:

- When and where did the theft take place?
- How was the theft carried out?
- A description of the thief
- Which other people were present and what did they do?

Ans:

Snatch Theft is on the Rise

- Vikrant Verma, Student Staff Reporter

Mumbai, 23rd December, 2019

Last evening, a snatch theft at the Dadar Bazar left the public in a state of shock. The incident raised a ruckus and the activity in the market came to a standstill.

A woman, who was talking to one of the vendors, suddenly cried out for help as a chain snatcher stole her chain and ran. Apparently, the man had been following the woman since the time she had entered the market. The woman only realised this after the theft was carried out. The thief was a man in his mid-thirties, with a height of around 5' 6". He was wearing a black shirt and green pants. Despite being chased by a couple of people, the thief still remains at large.

A police complaint was registered at the Dadar Police Station by the woman late last evening. The sub-inspector said, "This is the second chain-snatching incident reported this week. We will take strict action against those responsible for the thefts".

Q17. Prepare a news report based on the following headline:

[March 2020]

'Sweeper's daughter/son scores 96% in Class XII'

Ans:

Sweeper's Daughter scores 96% in Class XII

- Kanika Manek, Student Staff Reporter

Mumbai, 20th June 2020

In the city of dreams, yet another dream came true this morning - The dream of Naresh, a sweeper of 'The Lakeside High School and Jr. College' and his daughter Meenakshi. The same stage and halls Naresh once cleaned were decorated to felicitate his daughter who has secured 96% in her class XII exams.

As Meenakshi stepped onto the stage the entire school applauded her for her astounding feat. Her teachers were all in praise of her commitment, dedication and hard work.

As he was asked to address the crowd, a teary-eyed Naresh could not stop thanking the school's trust for financially supporting the dreams of his daughter. Meenakshi vowed to return back to the school one day as a teacher and help others like her realise and fulfil their dreams.

- Q7. Develop a story in about 80 to 100 words including a suitable title, with the following beginning:**
'He did not know much about the man, except that he could not be trusted...'

Ans:

The Stranger

He did not know much about the man, except that he could not be trusted. In the ten years that Abhimanyu had worked as a customs officer his instinct had never failed him. He could always tell when someone was trying to smuggle something across the border. And this time he was sure that the man in the yellow sedan was doing so. The only problem was that he had already stopped the man and searched his car six times in the last four weeks without finding any evidence of smuggling. Thus, the exercise was beginning to look ridiculous. The man however, never seemed to mind being stopped. In fact, he invariably had a smug expression on his face. One that said, "You will never find anything, no matter how hard you look". Naturally, this infuriated Abhimanyu even more. Finally, after searching the man's car on a couple more occasions, Abhimanyu decided to give up. It was twenty years later, when Abhimanyu, now retired, ran into the man at a bar. "I do not know how you did it. I do not know how you got away with it. But I know that you were smuggling something all those years." he said to the man. The man replied, with a twinkle in his eye, "Sure I was smuggling something. I was smuggling yellow sedans."

- Q8. Develop a story in about 80-100 words with the following ending. Give a suitable title:**
'... thus, that was the day Aanya learned that appearances could be deceiving'.

Ans:

Not Judging a Book by its Cover

It was a rainy day and Aanya was excited to use her new silk umbrella for the first time. It was a beautiful shade of blue and the water seemed to slide right off of it. She walked into the café at the corner of the street and stowed it with the other umbrellas. A few minutes later, she saw a well-dressed elderly gentleman pick up the umbrella and begin to make his way out of the café. She followed him and politely made him aware of the fact that the umbrella was hers. The old man however, was deeply offended at being accused of petty theft. He told Aanya that the umbrella was definitely his and it was she who was mistaken. Unsure of how to react, she decided to give the old man the benefit of the doubt. When she saw him struggle to get a cab, she even offered to drive him home. But after he got off, she felt like following him. To her utter surprise, instead of entering any of the residential buildings, he entered another café. And a few minutes later, walked out wearing a coat that was much fancier than the one he was originally wearing, with a beautiful green silk umbrella in his hand. Thus, that was the day Aanya learned that appearances could be deceiving.

- Q9. Develop a story in about 80-100 words with the following ending. Give a suitable title:**
'...Sahil realised that spreading rumours could quickly get out of hand'.

Ans:

The Rumour

It was Monday and Sahil was bored out of his mind. The thought of getting through two more weeks before the summer holidays began sent a shiver down his spine. He figured that he had to do something to make the idea of coming to school more appealing. Upon looking around he noticed that Sheena hadn't brought her expensive sling bag to school. Instead she had brought an old backpack that looked rather worn-out. Without a thought, he immediately turned to Sameer and said, "Did you notice Sheena's backpack? I heard that her family has fallen upon tough times. It's sad isn't it?" It was rather shocking how quickly Sahil forgot about this rumour that he spread but he was reminded of it quite sternly the next Monday. In the span of just one week, the rumour had gone from Sheena's family falling upon tough times to Sheena's father being fired from his job after being caught stealing money from his company. Standing in the Principal's office, as the student who started the rumour, Sahil realised that spreading rumours could quickly get out of hand.

- Q10. Develop a story in about 80-100 words with the following ending. Give a suitable title:**
'...after that day he started being grateful for everything he had'.

Ans:

The Things We Do Have

Mohan was a travelling salesman and it was an unwritten part of his job description that he would have to walk miles and miles every day. To the company, all that mattered was the number of milkshake mixers he had sold and not the number of doors he had knocked on or the number of stairs he had climbed. As the years had gone by, he had become used to the idea that some would rudely shut the door in his face. And, that some would converse with him for almost an hour and then make an excuse instead of a purchase. But what was now killing him was the realisation that he was not as young as he used to be. His thighs would sometimes pain through the night and his feet would hurt as if they would drop off. In such moments, he would envy the shopkeeper he bought groceries from each morning. According to him, the man was truly fortunate because all he had to do was sit behind a counter. The next morning, while buying his groceries he

within the flames, we saw a group of firefighters run towards us. Using the fire hose, they had the fire under control in no time. A lot of property had been damaged but the best part was that there was no loss of lives that day.

Q3. Narrate an experience in about 80-100 words with the following beginning. Give a suitable title to it.

‘It was my first time on a plane...’

Ans:

My First Time on a Plane

It was my first time on a plane. I tried my best to conceal this fact from my fellow flyers, but something tells me that they knew. Maybe it was because I would flinch at the tiniest sound or simply because I had no idea where to look or what to do. All I am sure of is that I felt incredibly out of place. After what seemed like an eternity, the flight finally took off. I had the window seat but did not dare to look out of the window. As each minute passed I kept reminding myself that this was a short flight. I just had to remain calm for three hours and I would be back on the ground. As if fate had heard me, the plane started shaking, violently. For me, my worst fear had come true and I was about to die. I had begun saying my prayers when the pilot made an announcement that I shall never forget. He said, “That was just a little bit of turbulence, nothing to worry. Please remain calm”. I could recognise that voice anywhere. It was my elder cousin’s voice and I immediately realised why my mom had insisted that I take this particular flight. The rest of the journey was one of the most pleasant experiences I have had and I am happy to share that now I regularly fly around the world.

Q4. Narrate an experience where you were saved by your dog.

‘.....thus we were saved in the nick of time due to our dog, Bittu’.

Ans:

The Heroic Act of Bittu

It was a Sunday and Dad was in charge of shopping and I tagged along with him. Sunday lunch was a grand affair at our house. We arrived at the meat shop to purchase the last item on our list. Today’s menu was Biryani and I had already begun to smell the aroma of delicious spices. After making our purchase, we started off in the direction of our house. Unnoticed to us, a pack of dogs began to follow us. They came running and surrounded us. One of them was about to bite me in order to steal the chicken, when our dog Bittu emerged out of the bushes. Otherwise a calm dog, he was ready to charge at them today. Looking at him, the other dogs decided that it was best to escape and thus we were saved in the nick of time due to our dog, Bittu.

Q5. Narrate an experience with the following ending. Give a suitable title to it.

‘...I decided that I would never lie again in my life’.

Ans:

Lesson for life

Last year, during my summer vacation, we didn’t go outstation due to some financial issues. I didn’t want my friend, Aman, and his family, who are our family friends, to know about this. So, on the first day of school, when Aman asked me, I lied that we had gone to Ooty. Our sisters were classmates too. On my insistence, my sister told the same lie to Aman’s sister, Sania. On returning from school, I even persuaded my mother to share the same story with Aman’s mother. Unfortunately, the lie soon got exposed when our fathers spoke to each other. That day, my mother and sister were proved liars, all because of me. I couldn’t face Aman as I was too full of guilt and shame. Since then, I decided that I would never lie again in my life.

Q6. Narrate an experience with the following ending. Give a suitable title to it.

‘...I realised that I could always count on my best friend.’

Ans:

A Friend in Need is a Friend Indeed

Our school’s Annual Day was just around the corner and I could not be more excited. For the first time, I was going to be on the stage instead of in the audience. My classmate, Raj, and I were going to be the anchors and had been rehearsing for two weeks. Originally, I had wanted my best friend, Kamal, to be my co-anchor but he was far too shy to step on-stage. I encouraged him as much as I could but in the end I had to approach Raj, who agreed immediately. However, since I needed brutally honest feedback, I made Kamal attend all of our rehearsals. As the day got nearer, I felt more and more confident about our preparation. On the morning of the day, I put on my suit and was all set to leave for school when my mother received the call. Raj had twisted his ankle while playing football and was in no shape to host the Annual Day with me. Of course, I was worried about Raj but I also had no idea what I was going to do. The script demanded two anchors. I could not be on-stage talking to myself. Somehow, I reached the school, almost with tears in my eyes because I could not believe this was happening. However, I was shocked to see that Kamal had turned up wearing a suit too. He had heard about what happened and told me that he had attended enough of our rehearsals to know the script by heart. When he hosted the Annual day with me, without thinking about himself for a minute, I realised that I could always count on my best friend.

Solved Textual Questions

- Q7. 'Music is the medicine of the mind'. Narrate an experience that leads to the above conclusion. Write it in your own words, in your own notebook.** (Lesson 3.2 – *The Night I Met Einstein*)

Ans: **'Music is the medicine of the mind'**

I was appearing for my class IX final examinations, last year, when this incident occurred. A few months earlier we had moved to Thane and I had to commute by train to and from my school. My final exams were scheduled at 7 a.m. I took the usual 6:12 train from Thane, and just as the train left the station, it stopped abruptly. Ten minutes later, everybody in the train compartment started panicking. I calculated that if the train would not start in another five minutes, I would be late for my exam. That's when I decided to listen to the light *sitar* music that my mother had downloaded on my phone. My mind began to slowly calm down and though I reached the exam hall a good 15 minutes late, I was able to do well and complete my paper, all because the music helped me relax before the examination. Music is indeed a medicine for the mind.

Board Exam Questions

- Q8. Narrate an experience in about 80-100 words beginning with the following words:** 'It was Sunday and I was enjoying the latest movie in the theatre with my parents....' [March 2019]

Ans: **The Unexpected Delight**

It was Sunday and I was enjoying the latest movie in the theatre with my parents, when the air-conditioner in the theatre stopped working. After a while, some people in the audience stood up and started yelling. There was chaos and the screening of the movie stopped. The manager himself walked in to apologise and explain that it was the failure of the air-conditioners and the generator, which had led to the inconvenience. The management sorted the issue in half an hour, and as a courtesy, they even offered everyone free popcorn during the interval. It was an unexpected and delicious delight!

- Q9. Narrate an experience of your own that has helped you to realise that 'patience is bitter, but its fruit is sweet'. Write it in about 100 words.** [July 2019] (Lesson 2.2 – *The Three Questions*)

Ans: **Patience is Bitter but its Fruit is Sweet**

I was at the mall with my parents when I saw it for the first time. It was a stunning digital watch with a yellow strap and a black dial. Its price tag, however, was equally stunning. I went up to my parents and told them about the watch as well as how I really really wanted it. Also, I proposed to them that if they bought me the watch I would not ask them for anything for the rest of the year. Still, my parents told me that we could spare no unnecessary expenses and that the watch was far too expensive. I was heartbroken. To come home without the watch on my wrist was the worst feeling ever. But I promised myself that I would save every penny I could from the pocket money I received each month and buy the watch. It took almost an entire year but the day finally arrived when I had the required amount. The happiness I felt when I walked out of the mall with the watch on my wrist was indescribable. And when I showed the watch to my parents they could not believe that I had been patient for such a long time. On that day I realised that patience is bitter but its fruit is sweet.

- Q10. Narrate an experience in about 80-100 words with the following ending. Give a suitable title:**

'.... I promised myself to work hard in order to achieve success'.

[March 2020]

Ans: **My Most Embarrassing Experience**

It was my preliminary examination and I had studied nothing. I scribbled something on my answer sheet but, everything was meaningless. Half of my answer sheet was blank. Soon, we were shown our paper in the classroom. I had secured the lowest marks. I was a class topper a few years ago. I was ashamed and decided to lie to my parents about my marks. As soon as I reached home I sat on the table to study. I didn't even go out to play. My dad was very happy to see me studying sincerely. My parents asked me about my marks. I lied and told them I scored full marks. My dad was very proud. He walked with pride on the open day. But his pride was short-lived. After seeing my report card, he gave me a stern look and didn't speak to me until we got home. I felt ashamed and embarrassed. When we got home, I apologised to my parents. I assured them that I would never lie to them again and I promised myself to work hard in order to achieve success.